University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

10,130: Paper Writing Clinic for Strategy Research

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Active participation, Analog, Individual work individual grade (20%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Written work, Digital, Individual work individual grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Individual work individual grade (40%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
10,130,1.00 Paper Writing Clinic for Strategy Research -- English -- Ambos Björn

Course information

Prerequisites

Enrollment is restricted to Ph.D. candidates who have successfully completed their thesis proposal (Vorstudie). Students further need to be researching in the area of corporate headquarters/headquarters-subsidiary relationships. The course will explicitly focus on these topic areas; experts from other universities will be participating as guests. As a prerequisite, the paper submitted for this course needs to be centered on corporate headquarters or headquarters-subsidiary relationships.

Learning objectives

The objectives of this course are:

- Further familiarization with the literature and research on corporate headquarters and headquarters-subsidiary relationships (general knowledge of the research stream is required)
- Discussion and development of papers to prepare them for publication
- Reviewing and evaluating the quality of other papers that are being prepared for submissions

Content

This PhD seminar will be focused on developing papers targeted at the corporate headquarters and headquarters-subsidiary relationship literature.

Students are required to prepare a full paper (about 25 pages double-spaced) and presentation before the course, ready for discussion during the seminar. Papers will be shared for mandatory reading among all participants before the seminar.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

The course is structured as block-seminar. It will be held over two consecutive days at an offsite location. Students will present their research and the paper prepared for this course, which will be discussed in detail among the participants. As this course is not on campus, please contact Craft Henley (carolyncraft.henley@unisg.ch) with questions regarding financing for hotel, travel, etc.

The preliminary dates for this course will be set and communicated as soon as possible.

Please note that any information in this fact sheet regarding date, time, and location is non-binding. Binding information regarding date, time, and location will be published in the course direcotry.

Literature

Introductory readings

Ambos TC, Birkinshaw J. 2010. Headquarters' attention and its effect on subsidiary performance. Management International Review (MIR) 50(4): 449-469.

Birkinshaw J, Braunerhjelm P, Holm U, Terjesen S. 2006. Why do some multinational corporations relocate their headquarters overseas? Strategic Management Journal 27(7): 681-700.

Birkinshaw J, Holm U, Thilenius P, Arvidsson N. 2000. Consequences of perception gaps in the headquarters-subsidiary relationship. International Business Review 9(3): 321.

Birkinshaw JM, Morrison AJ. 1995. Configurations of strategy and structure in subsidiaries of multinational corporations. Journal of International Business Studies 26(4): 729-753.

Hoenen AK, Kostova T. 2014. Utilizing the braoder agency perspective for studying headquarters-subsidiary relations in multinational conpanies. Journal of International Business Studies: 10.

Jarillo JC, Martínez JI. 1990. Different roles for subsidiaries: The case of multinational corporations in spain. Strategic Management Journal 11(7): 501-512.

Kunisch S, Mueller-Stewens G, Campbell A. 2014. Why corporate functions stumble. Harvard Business Review 92(10): 8.

Martinez JI, Jarillo JC. 1989. The evolution of research on coordination mechanisms in multinational corporations. Journal of International Business Studies 20(3): 489-514.

Nell PC, Ambos B. 2013. Parenting advantage in the MNC: An embeddedness perspective on the value added by headquarters. Strategic Management Journal 34(9): 1086-1103.

Paterson SL, Brock DM. 2002. The development of subsidiary-management research: Review and theoretical analysis. International Business Review 11(2): 139.

Additional readings

Aarland, K., Davis, J.C., Henderson, J.V. and Ono, Y. (2007). Spatial organization of firms: the decision to split production and administration. Journal of Economics, 38, pp. 480-494.

Aghion, P. and Tirole, J. (1995). Some implications of growth for organizational form and ownership structure. European Economic Review, 39, pp. 440-455.

Aksoy, A. and Marshall, N. (1992). The changing corporate head office and its spatial implications. Regional Studies, 26, pp. 149- 162.

Ambos, B., Asakawa, K. and Ambos, T.C. (2011). A dynamic perspective on subsidiary autonomy. Global Strategy Journal, 1, pp. 301-316.

Ambos, T.C., Andersson, U. and Birkinshaw, J. (2010). What are the consequences of initiative-taking in multinational subsidiaries? Journal of International Business Studies, 41, pp. 1099-1118.

Baaij, M.G., Mom, T.J.M., Van Den Bosch, F.A.J. and Volberda, H.W. (2012a). Should top management relocate across national borders? MIT Sloan Management Review, 53, pp. 17-18.

Baaij, M.G., Mom, T.J.M., Van Den Bosch, F.A.J. and Volberda, H.W. (2012b). Why do multinational corporations relocate core parts of their corporate headquarters abroad? Long Range Planning, doi: http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.lrp.2012.07.001.

Baaij, M.G., Van Den Bosch, F.A.J. and Volberda, H.W. (2004). The international relocation of corporate centres: are corporate centres sticky?, European Management Journal, 22, pp. 141-149.

Barner-Rasmussen, W., Piekkari, R. and Bjo¨rkman, I. (2007). Mobility of headquarters in multinational corporations. European Journal of International Management, 1, pp. 260-274.

Bergh, D.D. (1993). Watch the time carefully: the use and misuse of time effects in management research. Journal of Management, 19, pp. 683-705.

Birkinshaw, J. (2010). How one company is making China its first home. McKinsey Quarterly, No. 3, pp. 50-51.

Borini, F.M., Fleury, M.T.L. and Fleury, A. (2009). Corporate competences in subsidiaries of Brazilian multinationals. Latin American Business Review, 10, pp. 161-185.

Brouwer, A.E., Mariotti, I. and van Ommeren, J.N. (2004). The firm relocation decision: an empirical investigation. Annals of Regional Science, 38, pp. 335-347.

Campbell, A., Goold, M. and Alexander, M. (1995a). Corporate strategy: the quest for parenting advantage. Harvard Business Review, 73, pp. 120-132.

Campbell, A., Goold, M. and Alexander, M. (1995b). The value of the parent company. California Management Review, 38, pp. 79- 97.

Campbell, A., Kunisch, S. and Mu¨ller-Stewens, G. (2011). To centralize or not to centralize. McKinsey Quarterly, 2011, pp. 1-6.

Campbell, A., Kunisch, S. and Mu¨ller-Stewens, G. (2012). Are CEOs getting the best from corporate functions? MIT Sloan Management Review, 53, pp. 12-14.

Card, D., Hallock, K.F. and Moretti, E. (2010). The geography of giving: the effect of corporate headquarters on local charities. Journal of Public Economics, 94, pp. 222-234.

Chandler, A.D. (1962). Strategy and Structure: Chapters in the History of the American Industrial Enterprise. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Chandler, A.D. (1991). The functions of the HQ unit in the multibusiness firm. Strategic Management Journal, 12, pp. 31-50.

Cibin, R. and Grant, R.M. (1996). Restructuring among the world's leading oil companies, 1980-92. British Journal of Management, 7, pp. 283-302.

Collings, D.G., McDonnell, A., Gunnigle, P. and Lavelle, J. (2010). Swimming against the tide: outward staffing flows from multinational subsidiaries. Human Resource Management, 49, pp. 575-598.

Collis, D.J., Young, D. and Goold, M. (2007). The size, structure, and performance of corporate headquarters. Strategic Management Journal, 28, pp. 383-405.

Collis, D.J., Young, D. and Goold, M. (2012). The size and composition of corporate headquarters in multinational companies: empirical evidence. Journal of International Management, 18, pp. 260-275.

Cooke, F.L. (2006). Modeling an HR shared services center: experience of an MNC in the United Kingdom. Human Resource Management, 45, pp. 211-227.

Coulson-Thomas, C. (1992). Strategic vision or strategic rhetoric or reality? Long Range Planning, 25, pp. 81-89.

Cox, R.A.K. and Schultz, J.D. (2007). The initial US stock market effect on firms that announce corporate headquarters relocation. International Journal of Commerce & Management, 17, pp. 255-263.

Davis, J.C. and Henderson, J.V. (2008). The agglomeration of headquarters. Regional Science & Urban Economics, 38, pp. 445-460. Desai, M.A. (2009). The decentering of the global firm. World Economy, 32, pp. 1271-1290.

Durmusoglu, S.S., McNally, R.C., Calantone, R.J. and Harmancioglu, N. (2008). How elephants learn the new dance when headquarters changes the music: three case studies on innovation strategy change. Journal of Product Innovation Management, 25, pp. 386-403.

Economist (2008). Corporate restructuring - centres of attention: companies may still have too many heads at headquarters. The Economist, 15 November, pp. 68-68.

Economist (2014). Fighting the flab: corporate headquarters have put on weight, and need to slim down again. The Economist, 22 March, pp. 62-62.

Ferlie, E. and Pettigrew, A. (1996). The nature and transformation of corporate headquarters: a review of recent literature and a research agenda. Journal of Management Studies, 33, pp. 495-523.

Foss, N.J. (1997). On the rationales of corporate headquarters. Industrial & Corporate Change, 6, pp. 313-338.

Gao, W., Ng, L. and Wang, Q. (2011). Does corporate headquarters location matter for firm capital structure? Financial Management, 40, pp. 113-138.

Garvin, D.A. and Levesque, L.C. (2008). The multiunit enterprise. Harvard Business Review, 86, pp. 106-117.

Ghosh, C., Rodriguez, M. and Sirmans, C.F. (1995). Gains from corporate headquarters relocations: evidence from the stock market. Journal of Urban Economics, 38, pp. 291-311.

Goold, M. (1994). Learning new parenting skills. Long Range Planning, 27, pp. 138-140.

Goold, M. and Campbell, A. (1987). Strategies and Styles: The Role of the Centre in Managing Diversified Corporations. Oxford: Blackwell.

Goold, M. and Campbell, A. (2002). Do you have a well-designed organization? Harvard Business Review, 80, pp. 117-124.

Goold, M. and Luchs, K. (1992). Strategies and Styles Revisited. London: Ashridge Strategic Management Centre.

Goold, M., Campbell, A. and Luchs, K. (1993). Strategies and styles revisited: 'strategic control' - is it tenable? Long Range Planning, 26, pp. 54-61.

Goold, M., Campbell, A. and Luchs, K. (1993). Strategies and styles revisited: strategic planning and financial control. Long Range Planning, 26, pp. 49-60.

Goold, M., Campbell, A. and Alexander, M. (1994). Corporate-Level Strategy: Creating Value in the Multibusiness Company. New York, NY: Wiley.

Goold, M., Pettifer, D. and Young, D. (2001). Redesigning the corporate centre. European Management Journal, 19, pp. 83-91.

Gospel, H. and Sako, M. (2010). The unbundling of corporate functions: the evolution of shared services and outsourcing in human resource management. Industrial & Corporate Change, 19, pp. 1367-1396.

Gregory, R., Lombard, J.R. and Seifert, B. (2005). Impact of headquarters relocation on the operating performance of the firm. Economic Development Quarterly, 19, pp. 260-270.

Hansen, O.C. and Peytz, M. (1991). Designing the corporate center. McKinsey Quarterly, No. 3, pp. 128-139.

Henderson, J.V. and Ono, Y. (2008). Where do manufacturing firms locate their headquarters? Journal of Urban Economics, 63, pp. 431-450.

Holloway, S.R. and Wheeler, J.O. (1991). Corporate headquarters relocation and changes in metropolitan corporate dominance, 1980-1987. Economic Geography, 67, pp. 54-74.

Hungenberg, H. (1993). How to Ensure That Headquarters Add Value. Long Range Planning, 26, pp. 62-73.

Joseph, J. and Ocasio, W. (2012). Architecture, attention, and adaptation in the multibusiness firm: General Electric from 1951 to 2001. Strategic Management Journal, 33, pp. 633-660.

Kleinbaum, A.M. and Stuart, T.E. (2014). Inside the black box of the corporate staff: social networks and the implementation of corporate strategy. Strategic Management Journal, 35, pp. 24-47.

Klier, T. and Testa, W. (2002). Location trends of large company headquarters during the 1990s. Economic Perspectives, 26, pp. 12- 26.

Kontes, P. (2004). A new look for the corporate center: reorganizing to maximize value. Journal of Business Strategy, 25, pp. 18-24.

Kramer, R.J. (1999). Organizing for global competitiveness: the corporate headquarters design. Report R-1233-99-RR, The Conference Board.

Laamanen, T., Simula, T. and Torstila, S. (2012). Cross-border relocations of headquarters in Europe. Journal of International Business Studies, 43, pp. 187-210.

Landier, A., Nair, V.B. and Wulf, J. (2009). Trade-offs in staying close: corporate decision making and geographic dispersion. Review of Financial Studies, 22, pp. 1119-1148.

Lovely, M.E., Rosenthal, S.S. and Sharma, S. (2005). Information, agglomeration, and the headquarters of U.S. exporters. Regional Science & Urban Economics, 35, pp. 167-191.

Maljers, F.A. (1992). Inside Unilever: the evolving transnational company. Harvard Business Review, 70, pp. 46-52.

van Marrewijk, A.H. (2009). Corporate headquarters as physical embodiments of organisational change. Journal of Organizational Change Management, 22, pp. 290-306.

McCann, B.T. and Folta, T.B. (2008). Location matters: where we have been and where we might go in agglomeration research. Journal of Management, 34, pp. 532-565.

Melman, S. (1951). The rise of administrative overhead in the manufacturing industries of the United States 1899-1947. Oxford Economic Papers. New Series, 3, pp. 62-112.

Menz, M., Kunisch, S. and Collis, D.J. (2013). What do we know about corporate headquarters? A review, integration, and research agenda. Harvard Business School Working Paper No. 14-016. Available at http://ssrn.com/abstract=2316198.

Montague, R. (1986). Separate corporate headquarters have an economic impact on plant operations. American Business Review, 4, pp. 20-24.

Ohmae, K. (1989). Planting for a global harvest. Harvard Business Review, 67, pp. 136-145.

Pirinsky, C. and Wang, Q. (2006). Does corporate headquarters location matter for stock returns? Journal of Finance, 61, pp. 1991- 2015.

Porter, M.E. (1987). From competitive advantage to corporate strategy. Harvard Business Review, 65, pp. 43-59.

Purkayastha, S., Manolova, T.S. and Edelman, L.F. (2012). Diversification and performance in developed and emerging market contexts: a review of the literature. International Journal of Management Reviews, 14, pp. 18-38.

Rajan, R.G. and Wulf, J. (2006). The flattening firm: evidence from panel data on the changing nature of corporate hierarchies. Review of Economics & Statistics, 88, pp. 759-773.

Raynor, M.E. and Bower, J.L. (2001). Lead from the center. Harvard Business Review, 79, pp. 92-100.

Reger, G. (2004). Coordinating globally dispersed research centres of excellence - the case of Philips Electronics. Journal of International Management, 10, pp. 51-76.

Strauss-Kahn, V. and Vives, X. (2009). Why and where do headquarters move? Regional Science & Urban Economics, 39, pp. 168- 186.

Tomasko, R.M. (1987). Running lean, staying lean. Management Review, 76, pp. 32-38.

Tomasko, R.M. (1992). Restructuring: getting it right. Management Review, 81, pp. 10-15.

Useem, M. and Gottlieb, M.M. (1990). Corporate restructuring, ownership-disciplined alignment, and the reorganization of management. Human Resource Management, 29, pp. 285-306.

Voget, J. (2011). Relocation of headquarters and international taxation. Journal of Public Economics, 95, pp. 1067-1081.

Young, D. (1993). Headquarters staff - products of history or sources of distinctive skills? Long Range Planning, 26, pp. 139-141.

Young, D. and Goold, M. (1993). Effective Headquarters Staff: A Guide to Size, Structure and Role of Corporate Headquarters Staff. London: Ashridge Strategic Management Centre.

Young, D. et al. (2000). Corporate Headquarters: An International Analysis of Their Roles and Staffing. London: Pearson Education.

Young, D.J. (1998). Benchmarking Corporate Headquarters. Long Range Planning, 31, pp. 933-936.

Additional information

In addition to the Bidding-system/StudyNet, you will need to register directly with Craft Henley (carolyncraft.henley@unisg.ch).

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Active participation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	20%
Duration	--

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

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Examination-aid rule

Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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2. Examination sub part (2/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written work
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written work
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	Off Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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3. Examination sub part (3/3)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	40%
Duration	--

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
Presentation

Examination-aid rule

Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids

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Content

Paper on corporate headquarters/headquarters-subsidiary relationship written at home and submitted before the course

Presentation of the paper during class

In-class participation

Literature

A detailed reading list will be distributed in class.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).